

Design Guidelines

How to create and deliver a design for a MONO tee: one ink, black or white cotton, printed large on the back. Everything you need to make a design that prints well and passes our review first time.

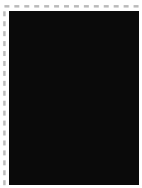
01 What we print

- **One ink.** Every design is printed in a single colour. No second colour, no gradients, no grey. Tones are made with dots or lines (halftone, hatching, stippling).
- **On the back.** The print sits high on the back of the tee, centred.
- **Black and white tees.** A design is offered on a black tee (printed in white ink) and on a white tee (printed in black ink). If your design only works on one of them, tell us.

What makes a good MONO design: strong line work, clear shapes and plenty of air. Think engraving, botanical plate, map, diagram, woodcut, typography, pattern, or a photograph turned into dots. The tee's colour is part of the design: leave room for it to show.

02 Design area: portrait, 26 × 35 cm

Design in portrait, not landscape. The design area is 26 cm wide by 35 cm tall: taller than it is wide, like the back of the tee. Compose your artwork to fill this upright shape.



26 cm wide
35 cm tall

✓ Portrait: fills the design area



26 cm wide
only ~17 cm tall

× Landscape: prints small, half the area empty

ITEM	SIZE (WIDTH × HEIGHT)
Design area (portrait)	26 × 35 cm, the size your artwork should fill
Full print area	28 × 37 cm; the extra centimetre on every side is a safety margin, keep artwork out of it
Small placement (optional)	12 × 12 cm square
Position	Centred left to right. The top of the design starts about 1 cm below the top of the print area

- The width is the limit: a design is never printed wider than 26 cm. A wide (landscape) artwork is scaled down to that width and ends up short, leaving the lower back empty.
- Align your design to the **top** of the area, not the middle. Don't leave a large empty band above it.

- The design should be substantial: at least 30% of the width and 30% of the height of the area. A thin strip across the chest or down the spine won't be accepted.

03 Files

Line art, type, geometry and patterns: vector (preferred)

- SVG, with a PDF or AI copy.
- One colour only (100% black). Transparent background, with no background rectangle.
- All text converted to outlines.
- No embedded images, gradients, transparency, effects, shadows or complex masks.
- Artboard: 26 × 35 cm, portrait (the design area). If you work on the full 28 × 37 cm area, keep all artwork inside the central 26 × 35 cm.

Photographs, engravings, brush and scanned work: raster

- PNG with a transparent background.
- 300 DPI at print size: 3071 × 4134 px (portrait) for the design area, 1417 × 1417 px for the small placement.
- 1-bit (ink or nothing), or greyscale that has already been screened into dots or lines. A continuous-tone greyscale photo cannot be printed in one ink.

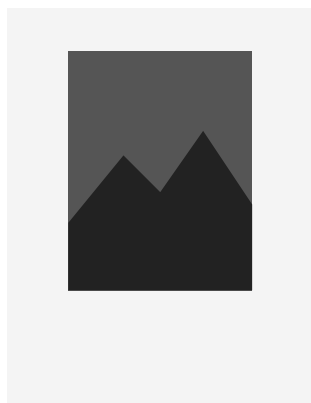
Two tee colours

- **Line art:** one file is enough. We print it in white on black tees and in black on white tees.
- **Photographs and any tonal work:** send two positives, because inverting a photo inverts its meaning:
 - ...-black.png: what prints in white ink on a black tee (the light parts of the picture are the ink);
 - ...-white.png: what prints in black ink on a white tee.

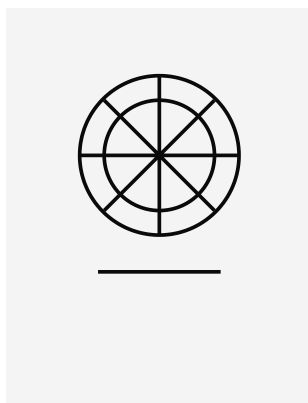
04 Ink: how much, and where

Every design is checked for these before it goes on sale. A design that fails is returned with the reason.

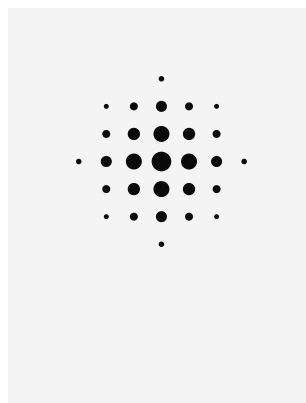
RULE	LIMIT
Total ink coverage	Between 4% and 32% of the print area
Photographs and scenes	The subject cut out, or the scene given one of the endings below: never the whole picture with its background
Frames and paper	No dark vignette around an empty middle, no scanned paper edges or shadows



× Photo with its background



✓ Open line work



✓ Halftone fading out

Scenes: how a picture ends

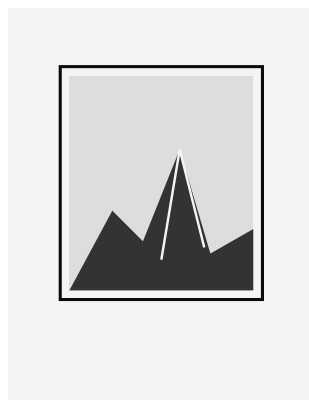
A scene drawn to its edges (a landscape, a coast, a sky) needs an ending. Choose one per design, before you draw, and compose for it:

ENDING	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE	SUITS
Horizon (the default)	The ground ends in one straight cut with a thin rule under it; the sides fall away and the sky is simply not drawn	Mountains, cliffs, dunes, a lighthouse
Plate	Cut to a rectangle with a thin keyline round it, like a museum plate or a postcard	Busy scenes: a forest, a lake, a fjord
Circle	Cut to a circle with a thin ring, like a lens or a seal	The moon, an island, a geyser, a planet
Arch	A rectangle with a round top and a keyline, like a window	Waterfalls, canyons, tall towers
Vignette	A soft fade to nothing all round	Sparingly: at most one design in ten, and only where it looks right

Keylines are a single thin line (0.5–1 mm) a few millimetres off the picture: a frame, never a filled box. Inside any ending, a plain light area (an empty sky) prints as nothing on the black tee.



✓ Horizon



✓ Plate



✓ Circle



✓ Arch

05 Lines, dots and text

ELEMENT	MINIMUM / RECOMMENDED
Line weight	Minimum 0.4 mm (thinner lines don't print reliably). A good hierarchy: 0.5 / 0.75 / 1.1 / 1.7 mm for hairline, fine, regular and bold
Halftone dots and the gaps between them	Minimum 0.4 mm
Text: capital height	Minimum 2.5 mm; 4 mm or more for text that must be read
Small detail	Any enclosed detail smaller than 0.4 mm will fill in when printed: simplify it

06 Words and type

- **Fonts:** only fonts licensed for commercial use on products (for example, SIL Open Font License). Tell us the font and its licence.
- **Language:** British English (colour, centre, metres). Typographic apostrophes and quotation marks (' " "), not straight ones (' ").
- **Not allowed:** brand names, logos, trademarks, copyrighted quotes or lyrics, and names of private individuals.

07 Rights

- Your own original work, or material in the **public domain** or under **CC0**. Licences that require attribution or forbid commercial use only by prior agreement.
- For archive material (museum and library collections), include the link to the source, the item number, the creator, the date and the licence.
- Photographs of people only with a model release, or when the photograph is in the public domain.
- Images made with generative tools: tell us which tool, and confirm its terms allow commercial use.
- By submitting, you confirm you have the right to grant **MONO** the rights to print and sell the design.

08 Details for each design

FIELD	WHAT TO WRITE
Title	In English, up to 40 characters, Title Case. Example: "The Fourteen Eight-Thousanders"
Category	One of: Photographs · Botanical & Nature · Maps & Sky · Architecture · Engravings · Brush & Woodblock · Pattern · Geometric · Type · ASCII & Code
Subject	What it shows, in a word or two. Example: Mountains
Style	Example: Halftone, Line drawing, Woodcut
Medium	Drawn (vector or illustration), photograph or scan
Description	One or two sentences in British English: what we see and where it comes from
Tee colours	Black, white, or both
Print size	The design's actual width × height in cm
Keywords	5 to 10 search words
Credit and source	Source and licence, where relevant

09 Delivery

One folder per design, zipped. File names in English, lower case, words joined by hyphens, no spaces.

<code>yourname-short-title/</code>	
<code>short-title.svg</code>	(or <code>short-title-black.png</code> + <code>short-title-white.png</code>)
<code>short-title-preview.png</code>	1500 px wide, the design on a black or white background
<code>short-title.txt</code>	the details from section 08
<code>sources/</code>	source files and licences, where relevant

10 Checklist before you submit

- ☐ One colour, transparent background, no gradients or grey
- ☐ Portrait design, 26 cm wide × 35 cm tall, aligned to the top
- ☐ Vector with text outlined, or PNG at 300 DPI (3071 × 4134 px, portrait)
- ☐ Tonal work: two positives, -black and -white
- ☐ Ink coverage between 4% and 32%; photographs cut out from their background
- ☐ Lines and dots at least 0.4 mm; capital height at least 2.5 mm
- ☐ Fonts and materials licensed for commercial use, sources included
- ☐ All details from section 08 filled in